

Central Intelligence Agency



Washington, D.C. 20505

2 September 2021

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Reference: F-2021-01247

Dear Requester:

This letter is a final response to your 17 March 2021 Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request for **all documents mentioning Walter Frederick LaFeber**. We processed your request in accordance with the FOIA (5 U.S.C. § 552, as amended, and the CIA Information Act, 50 U.S.C. § 3141, as amended).

Our processing included a search for records that would reveal a publicly acknowledged Agency association with the subject of your request existing up to and including the date the Agency started its search. We located 15 previously-released documents. Of these documents, 14 are publicly available and located in the FOIA Electronic Reading Room on our website at www.cia.gov/readingroom. We enclosed the one previously-released document not currently on the website.

To the extent that your request also seeks records, if any exist, that would reveal an unacknowledged or classified association with the subject(s) of your request, in accordance with Section 3.6(a) of Executive Order 13526, we can neither confirm nor deny the existence or nonexistence of such records. The admission of existence or nonexistence of such records is a fact that is exempt under FOIA. You may consider this finding a denial of this portion of your request pursuant to FOIA exemptions (b)(1) and (b)(3). Exemption (b)(3) pertains to information exempt from disclosure by statute. In this case, the relevant statutes are Section 6 of the Central Intelligence Agency Act of 1949, 50 U.S.C. § 3507, as amended, and Section 102A(i)(1) of the National Security Act of 1947, 50 U.S.C. 3024(i)(1), as amended.

As the CIA Information and Privacy Coordinator, I am the CIA official responsible for this determination. You have the right to appeal this response to the Agency Release Panel, in my care, within 90 days from the date of this letter. Please explain the basis for your appeal.

Please be advised that you may also seek dispute-resolution services from the CIA FOIA Public Liaison or from the Office of Government Information Services (OGIS) of the National Archives and Records Administration. OGIS offers mediation services to help resolve disputes between FOIA requesters and Federal agencies

To contact CIA directly with questions or to appeal the CIA's response to the Agency Release Panel:	To contact the Office of Government Information Services (OGIS) for mediation or with questions:
Information and Privacy Coordinator Central Intelligence Agency Washington, DC 20505 TEL: (703) 613-1287 FAX: (703) 613-3007	Office of Government Information Services National Archives and Records Administration 8601 Adelphi Road – OGIS College Park, MD 20740-6001 TEL: (202) 741-5770 FAX: (202) 741-5769 / ogis@nara.gov

Sincerely,



Mark Lilly
Information and Privacy Coordinator

Enclosure

16 January 1985

MEMORANDUM FOR: Chief, Intelligence Training

STAT

FROM:

[REDACTED]
Director of Training and Education

SUBJECT: Inviting Critics as Course Speakers

STAT

1. [REDACTED] asked that I provide him with some guidance as to our policy relating to inviting speakers who are critics of U.S. policies or who offer alternative or revisionist views. I support inviting such speakers where appropriate, since I think it is important for our students to be aware of what critics of Government positions may be saying and how they are saying it. We deal with mature, adult students, and we can assume that they put all speakers including critics into a proper perspective.

2. I would like to add two caveats to my approval to your inviting critical speakers. Firstly, I would like us to avoid inviting as speakers former senior Agency officials who hold alternate views on matters of current interest. It just seems to me that the inevitable comparisons between "how we did it then" and how it is being done now serve no real constructive purpose. Secondly, I ask that in each case where we invite someone to present alternate sides to issues and policies, we make it very clear to the students that we are involved in a deliberate attempt to provide them with alternate view points. I think this is only fair in terms of our management, students, and the speakers involved.

STAT

STAT

D/OTE [REDACTED] (16 Jan 85)

Distribution:

Orig - Addressee

~~1 - D/OTE~~

1 - ADC/OTE

4 Jan 85

Hal,

Advice and counsel, please!

STAT

One of our goals with AIS is to provide speakers who will provoke the class into considering alternative sides to issues and policies. I remember when [redacted] brought in Ronald Steele, a revisionist on US-Soviet relations, to address that topic.

STAT

I have a concern. I would posit that in the days of home-grown DCIs, it was almost fashionable to bring in all points of view into training programs as evidence of our openness and objectivity. A prime example was [redacted] a bona fide peacenik and hippie, who spoke to a Senior Seminar.

But with the advent of political DCIs, we seem to encourage folks like Richard Pipes and Konstantine Menges, but not those from the other end of the spectrum, to take part in our programs. I would like to find some good folks to raise basic questions about our policies in Central America, the Middle East, Africa, arms control, etc. Before we can look very far, we need some encouragement from management.

For openers, we would like to invite Randall Robinson, from Transafrica Lobby, to discuss South Africa, in the February AIS. Other possibilities...Walter LaFeber Cornell University, on Central America or more broadly, US foreign policy (he has written a couple of good studies on US-Soviet relations from a revisionist point of view), and individuals as yet unidentified who would be critics of Star Wars, barriers to technology transfer (perhaps from industry, identified by NCD), covert action in principle, US-Israeli relations, etc.

Can we get some guidance on Robinson soonest, and on the broader issue of identifying critics and inviting on a case-by-case basis in the near future?

Didc